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ACADEMIC VAULT

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THA 151: Speech and Communication for Stage and Media

Voice work, articulation and delivery that survive a microphone and a hall

THEATRE & FILM

Theatre & Film Studies

Faculty of Arts
Theatre & Film Studies | 100L

OUTLINE ARCHIVE: 2018 - 2019 - 2025/2026

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

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Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

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Why this pack exists

Your voice is an instrument that must be maintained and trained. This pack covers breathing and support, resonance, articulation, projection without strain, microphone technique, and the differences between stage delivery and broadcast delivery.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Support the voice with diaphragmatic breathing rather than throat tension.
- Identify and correct common Nigerian English articulation issues without shame.
- Project in a large hall without damaging the voice.
- Adapt delivery for radio, television and recorded voice-over.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Breath, support and resonance

Volume comes from breath support and resonance, not from shouting.

- Breathe low into the abdomen; shoulders should not rise.
- Control exhalation steadily to sustain a line to its end.
- Resonance chambers: chest, mouth and nasal cavities shape timbre.
- Warm up with humming, lip trills and gentle scales.
- Hydrate; avoid shouting over noise as a habit.
- Stop and rest if you feel pain or persistent hoarseness.

Articulation and accent

Intelligibility is the goal; erasing your accent is not.

- Work on final consonants, consonant clusters and word endings.
- Distinguish minimal pairs that affect meaning in your context.
- Mark stress in multisyllabic words and avoid misplaced stress.
- Pace and pausing carry meaning as much as pronunciation.
- Use tongue twisters for agility, not as a performance in themselves.
- Record yourself weekly and compare against a specific target, not a vague ideal.

> **Stage versus microphone**
> On stage you project to the back row; at a microphone you work close and controlled. Practise both, because the habits are different.

Delivery for stage and broadcast

The medium changes the technique.

- Stage: project, articulate for distance, sustain energy through long speeches.
- Radio: paint pictures with voice alone; pace and pause do the work of visual expression.
- Television: controlled energy, natural eyeline, awareness of framing.
- Voice-over: precise timing to picture, consistent tone, clean breaths.
- Interview or news reading: neutral warmth, accurate pronunciation of names.
- Always test the microphone and monitor before a recording.

Why your voice fails in a hall

Almost every "quiet" performer has the same problem: they are pushing air out with the throat instead of supporting it from the abdomen. Throat-based volume is thin, tires quickly and becomes hoarse by the second hour. Supported volume is louder with less effort because the breath stream is steady and the resonance spaces are open.

Support is mechanical, not mystical. Stand tall, let the lower ribs widen on the inhale, keep the shoulders quiet, and let the abdominal wall resist as you speak. The test is not how big a breath you can take but how evenly you can release it: count aloud on one breath and aim for a steady stream rather than a burst that collapses at eight.

Projection then depends on the space. A proscenium hall needs the voice aimed at the back wall, with consonants sharpened to carry; a small studio needs less volume and more variety. Performers who shout in small rooms damage their voices and flatten their range - the audience hears strain instead of meaning.

Articulation, accent and intelligibility